

KNOWLEDGE CONTENT GOVERNANCE & LIFECYCLE

Enterprise SOP for HR Knowledge Intake, Review, Publishing & Lifecycle Management

Document Type: Governance Framework / Standard Operating Procedure

Knowledge Domain: HR & Employee Services

Audience: Knowledge Management · HR SMEs · Content Owners · HR Service Owners

Scope: Enterprise HR Knowledge Content

Status: Controlled Document

Version: 1.0

Process Owner: HR Knowledge Management

Review Cycle: Annual Framework Review

Content Review Cycle: 180 Days

1. PURPOSE

This framework establishes a consistent process for creating, reviewing, publishing, maintaining, and retiring HR knowledge content.

The objective is to ensure that every published article is:

Accurate · Approved · Searchable · Current · Owned · Consistent · Reusable

The governance model provides clear controls from the initial **content request through retirement**, while enabling HR teams and SMEs to contribute content without compromising quality or consistency.

2. GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLES

ONE SOURCE OF TRUTH

Employees should be directed to approved knowledge rather than duplicate or conflicting information.

CLEAR OWNERSHIP

Every knowledge asset must have an accountable business owner and identified SME.

CONTROLLED PUBLISHING

Content should pass appropriate review and approval before becoming available to employees.

LIFECYCLE MANAGEMENT

Knowledge is continuously monitored, reviewed, updated, or retired as business needs change.

EMPLOYEE FIRST

Content should be written in clear, concise, actionable language based on employee needs.

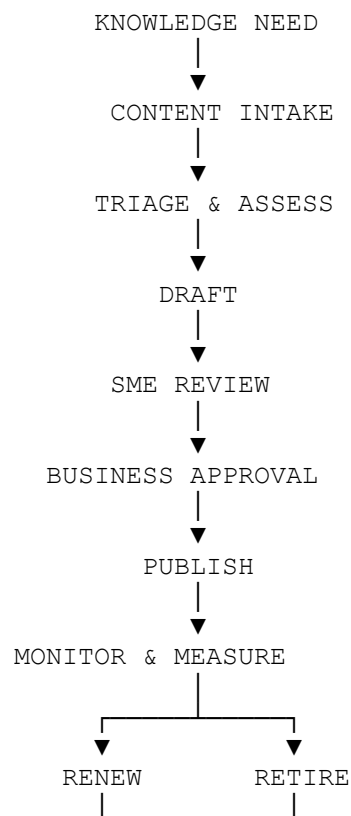
DATA-DRIVEN IMPROVEMENT

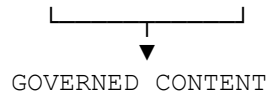
Search behavior, usage, feedback, case trends, and content quality metrics should inform ongoing improvements.

AI-READY GOVERNANCE

Knowledge should remain structured, trusted, current, and traceable so it can safely support search, virtual agents, chatbots, and AI/RAG experiences.

3. GOVERNANCE OPERATING MODEL





4. CONTENT INTAKE

All new knowledge requests should enter through a defined intake process.

CONTENT REQUEST SOURCES

- HR policy or process changes
- New HR services
- Employee questions and recurring cases
- Search gaps and zero-result searches
- New technology or system launches
- Regional or country-specific requirements
- Content identified during knowledge audits
- SME or HR Service Owner requests
- Employee feedback
- Virtual Agent / chatbot gaps
- AI knowledge requirements

REQUIRED INTAKE INFORMATION

Field	Description
Content Request	What knowledge is required?
Business Need	Why is the content required?
Audience	Employee, Manager, HR, Agent
HR Domain	Payroll, Benefits, Leave, etc.
Region / Country	Applicable geography
Content Owner	Business owner
SME	Subject matter expert
Source	Policy, process, system, or approved reference
Priority	High, Medium, Low
Required Date	Target completion date

5. CONTENT TRIAGE

Knowledge Management assesses each request before drafting begins.

TRIAGE CHECK

Is the content already available?

Knowledge Governance | Content Lifecycle | SME Governance | ServiceNow | SharePoint | HR Self-Service | Content Quality | AI-Ready Knowledge

→ Reuse, update, or consolidate existing content.

Is similar content available?

→ Check for duplication and determine whether content should be merged.

Is the request valid?

→ Confirm business need and appropriate owner.

Is the source authoritative?

→ Validate the policy, process, system, or approved business source.

Who owns the content?

→ Assign accountable owner and SME.

Who needs the information?

→ Define the target persona and applicable geography.

6. CONTENT DEVELOPMENT

Content is created using standardized templates and writing principles.

CONTENT STANDARDS

Title

Use clear, employee-friendly language that reflects likely search terms.

Introduction

Explain what the article covers and when it should be used.

Action / Resolution

Provide clear steps or information required to complete the task.

Eligibility / Applicability

Identify who, where, and when the information applies.

Related Content

Connect relevant articles, services, policies, or resources.

Escalation

Explain what the employee should do if self-service does not resolve the issue.

WRITING PRINCIPLES

- Use plain language.
 - Keep sentences concise.
 - Use meaningful headings.
 - Prefer numbered steps for procedures.
 - Avoid unnecessary technical terminology.
 - Write for the intended persona.
 - Use consistent HR terminology.
 - Make content easy to scan.
 - Include relevant search keywords and synonyms.
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7. SME REVIEW

The SME validates the business accuracy of the content before approval.

SME VALIDATES

- Policy accuracy
- Process accuracy
- Eligibility criteria
- Required steps
- Exceptions
- Regional / country applicability
- System information
- Effective dates
- Supporting references

SME OUTCOME

Approved → Move to business approval.

Changes Required → Return to Knowledge Management for revision.

Rejected / Not Required → Close the request with appropriate reason.

8. BUSINESS APPROVAL

Content requiring formal business approval must be reviewed by the appropriate **Content Owner / HR Service Owner / Policy Owner**.

APPROVAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ Content is factually accurate
- ☐ Correct audience identified

- ☐ Correct geography identified
- ☐ Source information validated
- ☐ Links and references verified
- ☐ Metadata completed
- ☐ Owner and SME identified
- ☐ Review date defined
- ☐ Related content reviewed
- ☐ No conflicting or duplicate content identified

Only approved content should proceed to publication.

9. PUBLISHING

Approved content is published to the appropriate knowledge platform or repository.

PUBLISHING CONTROLS

Before publication:

- Apply approved article template.
- Complete mandatory metadata.
- Assign knowledge category.
- Add keywords and synonyms.
- Set audience and applicability.
- Assign content owner.
- Set review date.
- Confirm version number.
- Validate links.
- Preview the published experience.
- Confirm search visibility.

TARGET PLATFORMS

- ServiceNow Knowledge
- SharePoint
- Employee portals
- HR knowledge repositories
- Virtual Agent / chatbot knowledge sources
- AI / RAG knowledge repositories

10. VERSION CONTROL

Every controlled knowledge asset should have traceable version information.

VERSION MODEL

Major Version — Significant Content Change

Example:

2.0

Used for substantial policy, process, or structural changes.

Minor Version — Routine Update

Example:

2.1

Used for corrections, clarifications, formatting, links, or minor updates.

CHANGE RECORD

Each significant update should capture:

- Version
- Date
- Change description
- Updated by
- Reviewer
- Approver
- Reason for change

11. CONTENT RENEWAL

Published knowledge should not be considered permanently valid.

REVIEW TRIGGER

A standard review cycle of **180 days** is used for applicable HR knowledge content.

Additional reviews may be triggered by:

- Policy changes
- Process changes
- Organizational changes
- System changes
- Regulatory changes

- Employee feedback
- High-volume cases
- Poor search performance
- Low content usefulness
- Incorrect or outdated information

RENEWAL OUTCOMES

KEEP

Content remains accurate and requires no changes.

UPDATE

Content requires modifications.

CONSOLIDATE

Content should be merged with another knowledge asset.

RETIRE

Content is no longer required or valid.

12. CONTENT RETIREMENT

Content should be retired when it is no longer accurate, relevant, or required.

RETIREMENT TRIGGERS

- Policy discontinued
- Process replaced
- System retired
- Duplicate content consolidated
- Service discontinued
- Organization change
- Content superseded
- Information no longer applicable

RETIREMENT PROCESS

```
Identify obsolete content
↓
Confirm with Content Owner
↓
Check for replacement content
↓
Redirect users where appropriate
↓
Remove from active search
↓
Archive / retain according to policy
↓
```


Record retirement

Retirement should be controlled rather than simply deleting content, particularly where historical traceability is required.

13. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Role	Key Responsibility
Knowledge Management	Architecture, standards, workflow, governance, quality and lifecycle
Content Owner	Business accountability and content accuracy
SME	Subject expertise, validation and review
HR Service Owner	Service/process alignment and approval
HR Technology / ServiceNow Owner	Platform configuration and technical alignment
Regional / Local HR	Local policy and process variations
Internal Communications	Employee messaging and communication alignment
Employees / Users	Feedback, content discovery and issue reporting

14. RACI MODEL

Activity	KM	Content Owner	SME	HR Service Owner
Content Intake	R	C	C	C
Triage	R	C	C	C
Drafting	R	C	C	I
SME Review	C	C	R/A	I
Business Approval	C	A	R	A
Publishing	R	C	I	I
Lifecycle Management	R	A	C	C
Renewal	R	A	R	C
Retirement	R	A	C	C
Reporting	R	C	I	C

R = Responsible · A = Accountable · C = Consulted · I = Informed

15. CONTENT QUALITY GATES

Knowledge Governance | Content Lifecycle | SME Governance | ServiceNow | SharePoint | HR Self-Service | Content Quality | AI-Ready Knowledge

Each knowledge asset passes through defined quality gates.

GATE 01 — INTAKE

Business need confirmed?

Owner identified?

Audience defined?



GATE 02 — CONTENT

Correct template?

Plain language?

Searchable?

Actionable?



GATE 03 — VALIDATION

SME reviewed?

Source verified?

Regional applicability confirmed?



GATE 04 — APPROVAL

Business owner approved?



GATE 05 — PUBLISH

Metadata complete?

Review date assigned?

Links validated?



GATE 06 — MONITOR

Usage measured?

Search performance reviewed?

Feedback considered?

16. KNOWLEDGE QUALITY SCORECARD

Dimension	Measurement
Freshness	% content reviewed within required cycle
Ownership	% content with assigned owner
Metadata Quality	% content meeting metadata standards
Searchability	Search success / zero-result rate
Accuracy	SME / business validation results
Usage	Article views and engagement
Self-Service	Case deflection / successful self-service
Content Health	Duplicate, obsolete and conflicting content
Employee Experience	Feedback / satisfaction
AI Readiness	Structured, governed and retrievable content

17. GOVERNANCE DASHBOARD

A knowledge governance dashboard can provide visibility across the content ecosystem.

CONTENT HEALTH

Total Knowledge Assets
Published Content
Under Review
Overdue Reviews
Retirement Candidates

GOVERNANCE

% With Owner
% With SME
% With Complete Metadata
% Reviewed on Time

EXPERIENCE

Top Searches
Zero-Result Searches
Top Articles
Low-Performing Articles
Employee Feedback

SERVICE IMPACT

Case Deflection
Repeat Inquiries
Virtual Agent Resolution
Self-Service Adoption

18. AI & RAG GOVERNANCE

As HR knowledge becomes available to AI-powered experiences, governance becomes even more important.

BEFORE AI RETRIEVAL

Approved

→ Is the content authorized?

Current

→ Has it passed the required review cycle?

Relevant

→ Does it apply to the employee's persona, country, and context?

Structured

→ Is the information organized for reliable retrieval?

Traceable

→ Can the source, owner, and version be identified?

Safe

→ Does the content follow appropriate access and information-handling controls?

PRINCIPLE

AI should amplify governed knowledge, not compensate for poorly governed knowledge.

19. STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

STEP 01 — IDENTIFY

Identify a new knowledge requirement or content gap.

STEP 02 — INTAKE

Capture the request, audience, business need, source, owner, SME, and priority.

STEP 03 — ASSESS

Check existing content, duplication, applicability, and authoritative sources.

STEP 04 — DRAFT

Create content using approved templates and writing standards.

STEP 05 — REVIEW

Submit content to the appropriate SME for validation.

STEP 06 — APPROVE

Obtain required business / service owner approval.

STEP 07 — PUBLISH

Apply metadata, taxonomy, ownership, review date, and version before publishing.

STEP 08 — MONITOR

Track usage, search behavior, feedback, content quality, and service impact.

STEP 09 — RENEW

Review content at the defined lifecycle interval or when a change occurs.

STEP 10 — RETIRE

Retire, archive, or consolidate obsolete content and maintain appropriate traceability.

20. GOVERNANCE WORKFLOW SUMMARY

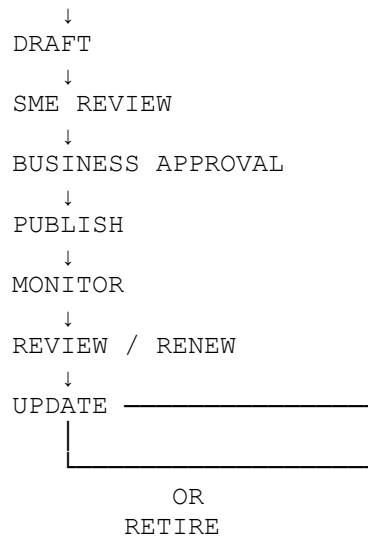
REQUEST



INTAKE



TRIAGE



21. MY GOVERNANCE APPROACH

I treat knowledge as a **managed enterprise asset rather than a collection of documents**.

My approach is built around six principles:

01 — STRUCTURE

Create a consistent architecture, taxonomy, metadata model, and content template.

02 — OWNERSHIP

Assign clear business ownership and SME accountability.

03 — CONTROL

Introduce defined review, approval, publishing, versioning, and retirement controls.

04 — EXPERIENCE

Design content around employee needs, personas, search behavior, and self-service journeys.

05 — MEASURE

Use analytics, feedback, search trends, and service data to identify improvement opportunities.

06 — EVOLVE

Continuously clean, harmonize, update, and prepare knowledge for emerging AI and conversational experiences.

PORTFOLIO NOTE

What this demonstrates

This artifact demonstrates my ability to design and operationalize **enterprise knowledge governance**, covering the complete content lifecycle from **intake and drafting through SME validation, approval, publishing, renewal, and retirement**.

The framework brings together **content ownership, quality gates, version control, review cycles, taxonomy, metadata, analytics, self-service, and AI/RAG readiness** into a practical operating model.

The goal is to ensure that employees consistently access **trusted, current, searchable, and actionable knowledge** across the enterprise.